Christian Fuertes

Engineering Manager · Hands-on leadership across frontend, backend and DevOps

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PROFILE

Hands-on Engineering Manager with 14 years in software engineering and 6+ years leading teams. At Qualifyze I lead a cross-functional team of up to 15 people across frontend, backend, infrastructure, data and product, with 6 direct reports, owning delivery and technical health end to end.
Deep TypeScript expertise across React, Next.js and Node.js, with working DevOps fluency on AWS (CI/CD, containers, monitoring, Terraform). Experience across B2B SaaS in a regulated industry, e-commerce, connected hardware and electric mobility, security software and data platforms.
Epic lead time cut from 5 to 2 days, 90%+ test coverage, critical incidents fixed in under 30 minutes and strong team retention. I still ship code across TypeScript and Java services, led my team's adoption of Claude Code and pushed for a cross-team repository of Claude Code skills.

CORE STRENGTHS

- **People leadership:** hiring, 1:1s, career plans, performance reviews and improvement plans; high retention and internal promotions, including growing a developer into an Engineering Manager.
- **Delivery ownership:** product and project delivery from problem definition to release, with roadmaps, OKRs and a predictable cadence.
- **Technical leadership:** architecture decisions documented through ADRs and RFCs, code reviews and team engineering standards: outside-in TDD, Definition of Done, small reviewed PRs.
- **Reliability:** monitoring, alerting and fast incident fixes, with postmortems that turn incidents into better alerting and processes.
- **Generative AI:** LLM-powered product features, RAG and agentic workflows with OpenAI, Anthropic and AWS Bedrock; spec-driven, AI-assisted development with Claude Code and human review on every PR.

EXPERIENCE

Engineering Manager

Qualifyze

October 2023 - Present · Barcelona, Spain (remote) · B2B scale-up, pharma supplier quality and compliance

- Lead a cross-functional team of up to 15 people across frontend, backend, infrastructure, data and product, with 6 direct reports. Report to the Head of Engineering and the CTO; regularly stand in for the Head of Engineering, leading hiring end to end.
- Own delivery from problem definition to release. Cut average epic delivery time from 5 to 2 days within a month by splitting epics into smaller units of value and improving cross-team alignment; PR review turnaround down 20%.
- Main decision maker on architecture and technical direction; ADRs and RFCs, and technical proposals to the CTO, CPO and leadership. Defined the team's standards: outside-in TDD, Definition of Done, small Draft PRs with mandatory code review and QA. Test coverage above 90%, fewer than 3 bugs per month.
- Hands-on across NestJS and Java/Spring Boot backends, a React/Next.js frontend and a dbt/Dagster warehouse on Redshift. Led a data migration to a new serving database and built a parity-check harness that gated the cutover on identical output.
- Contributed to the design of LLM-powered features used by customers: RAG-based document extraction from audit reports and certificates, and retrieval-augmented search, on OpenAI, Anthropic and AWS Bedrock, evaluated against validated datasets.
- Led my team's adoption of Claude Code with AI norms, including when not to rely on it, and human review on every PR. Pushed for a cross-team repository of AI agent skills shipped as a Claude Code plugin marketplace, now contributed to by engineering, QA and data, and built an internal community of practice. Introduced spec-driven refinement (epic, technical spec with API contracts, tickets).
- Fixed a critical shared-database failure in under 30 minutes and took part in the postmortem, which introduced a cross-team protocol for shared-database changes; fixed the N+1 query behind recurring API outages myself. Only 2 major incidents in 3 years.
- Cloud-native systems on AWS (ECS, Lambda, RDS, S3, CloudFront, API Gateway, Bedrock) with CI/CD, Docker, monitoring and alerting; IAM, secrets and WAF hardening.

- Participated in hiring about 10 engineers, with only 2 departures. 2 promotions, including growing a developer into an Engineering Manager through 1:1s, shadowing and acting as my deputy.

Lead Developer

Wallbox Chargers

February 2021 - March 2023 · Barcelona, Spain · Electric vehicle charging

- Lead developer for voice assistant and smart home integrations of a connected EV charging product: device communication backends, event-driven architecture on AWS Lambda, i18n.
- Datadog monitoring, Terraform and GitLab CI; Mixpanel analytics to improve UX. Defined roadmap and OKRs with Product and ran stakeholder demos.

Team Leader & Senior Developer

pEp Security SA

August 2018 - May 2020 · Barcelona, Spain · Security software

- Team lead and lead architect of an email encryption extension for a major open-source email client. Built a TDD-based quality culture and managed delivery.

Lead Developer

BRANDCRUMB

September 2014 - August 2018 · Barcelona, Spain · Data platforms

- Node.js data ingestion pipelines on AWS (Redshift, RDS). Architecture design, client requirements, junior mentoring and hiring.

CTO

Agorique

June 2013 - July 2014 · Barcelona, Spain · B2B e-commerce

- Head of Technology for a B2B online sales platform and virtual showroom (Ruby on Rails, Backbone): catalog, ordering and payments. Led the technical and design team.

PHP Developer

LetsBonus (a LivingSocial company)

April 2012 - May 2013 · Barcelona, Spain · B2C e-commerce

- Built the new high-traffic B2C e-commerce platform (catalog, checkout, payments, coupons) and prepared it for flash-sale and seasonal campaign peaks with caching, CDN and load testing.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (BSc), Computer Engineering

Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya (UPC)

2005 - 2012 · Barcelona, Spain

SKILLS

- **Frontend:** React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML/CSS
- **Backend:** Node.js, Express, NestJS, Java/Spring Boot, REST APIs, event-driven architecture, SQL, third-party integrations, Python (scripting)
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS (EC2, ECS, Lambda, S3, CloudFront, RDS, Redshift, API Gateway, Bedrock), Docker, Terraform, CI/CD (GitLab CI, GitHub Actions), Datadog
- **Data:** SQL, Redshift, dbt, Dagster, Liquibase
- **AI:** OpenAI, Anthropic Claude, AWS Bedrock, RAG, agents, function calling, MCP, Claude Code (skills, subagents, hooks)
- **Domains:** B2B SaaS, regulated industries (pharma), e-commerce and payments (Stripe, Shopify), IoT, electric mobility, data platforms, security software
- **Languages:** English (full professional, daily working language), Spanish (native), Catalan (native), French (basic)